



AI with Rav

Learn AI the way you actually think.



DAY 6 of 30

HACKATHONS

Why your progress bar is lying

WHAT YOU'LL LEARN TODAY

- > The fake progress bar pattern
- > How to spot one in seconds
- > What a real one looks like
- > Why judges check this



Why your progress bar is lying

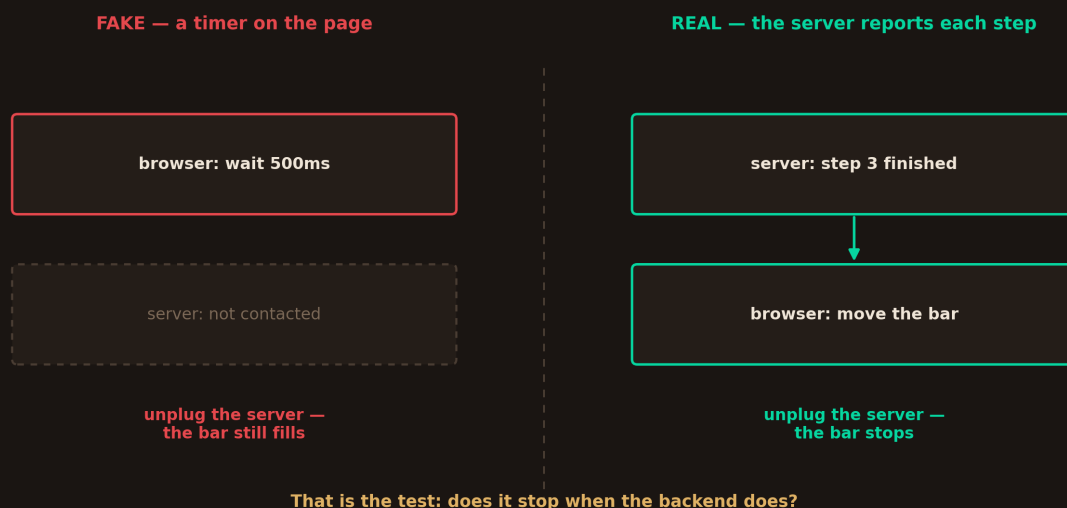
In One Line: If your progress bar would still move with the backend switched off, it is an animation — not progress.

The pattern almost every demo has

A loop on the frontend:

```
for each agent:
  show "running"
  wait 500ms
  show "done"
```

It looks convincing. It is connected to nothing. Kill the server and the bar still fills, all the way to 100%.



Left: a timer that ignores the backend. Right: each step reported by the server as it finishes.

Mine had two of them

My app ran a 500ms timer in the service **and** a separate 550ms timer moving the canvas nodes. Neither touched the backend.

Meanwhile the real work took **34 milliseconds**. The bar was pure theatre in both directions — too slow for the truth, entirely disconnected from it.

What honest progress looks like



The server streams each step as it actually completes. The bar moves because something finished — and if the server dies, the bar stops. That is the tell.

But real work is too fast to watch

34ms of dictionary lookups is not a demo. So I kept a deliberate pace — and said so on screen:

"Step timing is scaled from measured API latency · ~28s against live ad platforms"

Shaped timing you disclose is honest. A timer you pass off as progress is not.

Next video: the last one — how to ship the honest version without making it boring.

